him very well if it was the case only that ‘during the past month, it was a privilege to listen to the story of Bhagat Singh’s patriotism, his courage and his deep love for Indian humanity’.[23] And yet, Gandhi still could not resist the opportunity of a jibe at his erstwhile rival on grounds that ‘he misused his extraordinary courage . . .’.[24] The truth is that it was not Bhagat Singh who misused his courage but Gandhi who did not use his courage to save Bhagat Singh. Gandhi was not slow to acknowledge, however, how he stood to benefit from what he described as Irwin’s ‘grave blunder’. Bhagat Singh’s death, he declared, ‘has increased our power for winning the freedom for which Bhagat Singh and his comrades have died’.[25]